RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

18 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 8:55 AM, Sunday 18 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 364 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 42 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,330 minutes at 9:00 AM; Dammam moving, 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,330 minutes at 9:00 AM; GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 364 flights cancelled for Sunday so far (63% of scheduled), with flynas XY318 from Lahore diverted to Dammam.
- Aviation accounts say Riyadh's closure notice expired but every flight now needs prior permission; no GACA statement.
- Air Cairo reportedly extends its Riyadh suspension to Tuesday 20 October; Houthis claim a Saudi drone was downed over Hajjah, unconfirmed.
- Dammam airport moving: 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour, latest flyadeal F3461 to Madinah at 8:17 AM and flynas XY402 from Jeddah at 8:10 AM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9326 min).

364	0/0	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

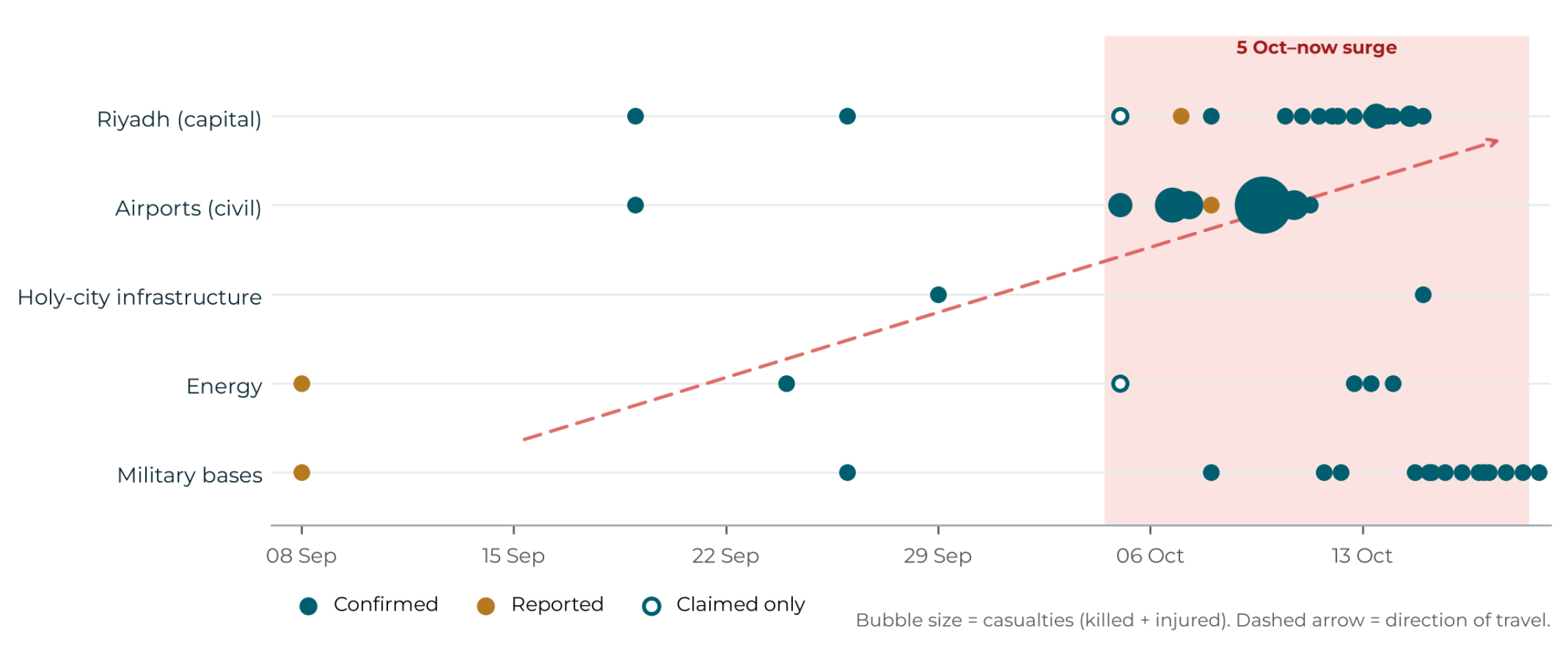
1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

42	1/1	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (9,330 min at 9:00 AM); no GACA reopening announcement
- A second aviation account says Riyadh flights now need prior permission; still no official statement
- Air Cairo reportedly extends its Riyadh flight suspension to Tuesday 20 October
- Houthis claim a Saudi Caracal drone was downed over Hajjah, Yemen; no coalition comment
- Dammam moving: 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 18 OCT



50 sourced events since 8 September (44 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region (18 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 8:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 8:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 5, alerts 6, all-clears 6, casualty reports 1.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

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Riyadh airport still halted; aviation accounts say flights need prior permission; Dammam moving

Checked at 9:00 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CLAIM **Houthi spokesman claims a Saudi Caracal drone was shot down over Hajjah, Yemen**

Yahya Saree, reported by Hurriyat (@HurriyatEN) · **8:42 AM** · posted 8:42 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; Houthi claim, no coalition comment; checked 9:00 AM

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree claims his forces shot down a Saudi Caracal drone over Hajjah province, which he called the fourth downed so far. The coalition has not commented, and the claim is not independently verified.

CORROBORATED **Aviation accounts say the Riyadh closure notice expired, but arrivals and departures still need prior permission**

Trips N' Maps (@tripsNmapsX), FlightCore Info (@FlightCoreinfos), The Contrail · **8:37 AM** · first posted 7:10 AM, repeated by FlightCore Info at 8:37 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; no GACA statement; checked 9:00 AM

Two aviation-tracking accounts and The Contrail say the closure NOTAM for King Khalid International expired at midnight on 17 October, but new notices require prior permission for every arrival and departure and bar its use as an alternate. GACA has not announced a reopening, and the Flightradar24 board still shows no Riyadh movements.

UNVERIFIED **Air Cairo extends its suspension of Riyadh flights from Cairo, Assiut and Sohag until Tuesday 20 October**

Report citing an Air Cairo statement (@hamedezzeldin) · **8:24 AM** · posted 8:24 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; airline statement not seen directly; checked 9:00 AM

A post citing an Air Cairo statement says the airline has extended the suspension of all its flights to King Khalid International from Cairo, Assiut and Sohag until Tuesday 20 October, pending the airport's return to normal operations. We have not seen the statement on Air Cairo's own channels.

CONFIRMED **SPA: weather service warns of thunderstorms, hail and fog, including coastal parts of the Eastern Province**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 9:00 AM

The national weather service expects moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash floods, hail and strong winds over Jazan, Asir, Al Baha and Makkah, with fog forming there and on the coastal parts of the Eastern Province, where Dammam airport is.

CONFIRMED **Philippines: first 34 Filipino workers from Riyadh due home on Monday as more await flights**

Philippine News Agency (@pnagovph) · **6:51 AM** · published 6:51 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (Philippine government news agency); checked 9:00 AM

The Philippine News Agency says the first batch of 34 overseas Filipino workers from Riyadh is expected to arrive on Monday, with the government arranging repatriation of hundreds more.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman rejects Houthi claim that a Saudi Apache was shot down**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); Arab News · **6:40 AM** · posted 6:40 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; Arab News report 6:58 AM; checked 9:00 AM

The coalition spokesman's account said the Houthis 'claim to have shot it down' and that the Apache 'will enter the field soon'. Arab News reported the spokesman denied the Houthi shoot-down claim; the coalition says the Najran crash was a technical fault.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: National Guard reconnaissance helicopter crashed in Najran region from a technical fault; both officers killed**

Coalition spokesman via SPA (@SPAregions) and Al Ekhbariya · **6:12 AM** · published 6:11 to 6:12 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; SPA at 7:12 AM confirmed the AH-6i belonged to the National Guard Ministry; checked 9:00 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said an AH-6i reconnaissance helicopter of the National Guard crashed in the Najran region because of a technical fault, killing its two-officer crew. The Houthis claim they shot it down; the coalition says it was a malfunction, and there is no independent evidence of a shoot-down.

UNVERIFIED DMM **Social accounts claim air traffic halted at Dubai International, with inbound jets holding**

Social accounts on X (@CocoPostel, @abw__zayd) · **4:51 AM** · posted 4:39 to 4:51 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; not confirmed by Dubai Airports; checked 4:52 AM

Several accounts say flight trackers show Emirates jets holding east of Dubai and claim traffic was stopped shortly after the Dammam halt. Dubai Airports had posted nothing by 4:52 AM, so this is unconfirmed.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **3:16 AM** · published 3:16 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); Al Ekhbariya carried it at 3:17 AM and SPA at 3:17 AM; checked 3:58 AM; SPA English relayed both intercepts at 3:55 AM (https://x.com/Spa_Eng/status/2111622207810031814)

The Coalition spokesman said a second drone of the night was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region, after the 1:39 AM interception. No casualties, debris or damage were mentioned.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in the Eastern Region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **3:10 AM** · published 3:10 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); Al Ekhbariya and SPA carried it at 3:11 AM; checked 3:58 AM; SPA English relayed both intercepts at 3:55 AM (https://x.com/Spa_Eng/status/2111622207810031814)

The Coalition spokesman said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Eastern Region, which includes Dammam. Dammam airport has shown no takeoff or landing since 2:49 AM. No casualties, debris or damage were mentioned.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

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Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9326 min).

364	—	—	0	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
193 departures + 171 arrivals, 63% of 577 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:55 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 364 at 8:56 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**193**	**171**	**364**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**193 (63%)**	**171 (63%)**	**364**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**0 (0%)**	**0 (0%)**	**0**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**2 (100%)**	**0 (0%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 88**	**0 of 47**	**0 of 135**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	**1**	**1**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**12**	**29**	**41**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**18**	**23**	**41**	FR24 stats panel

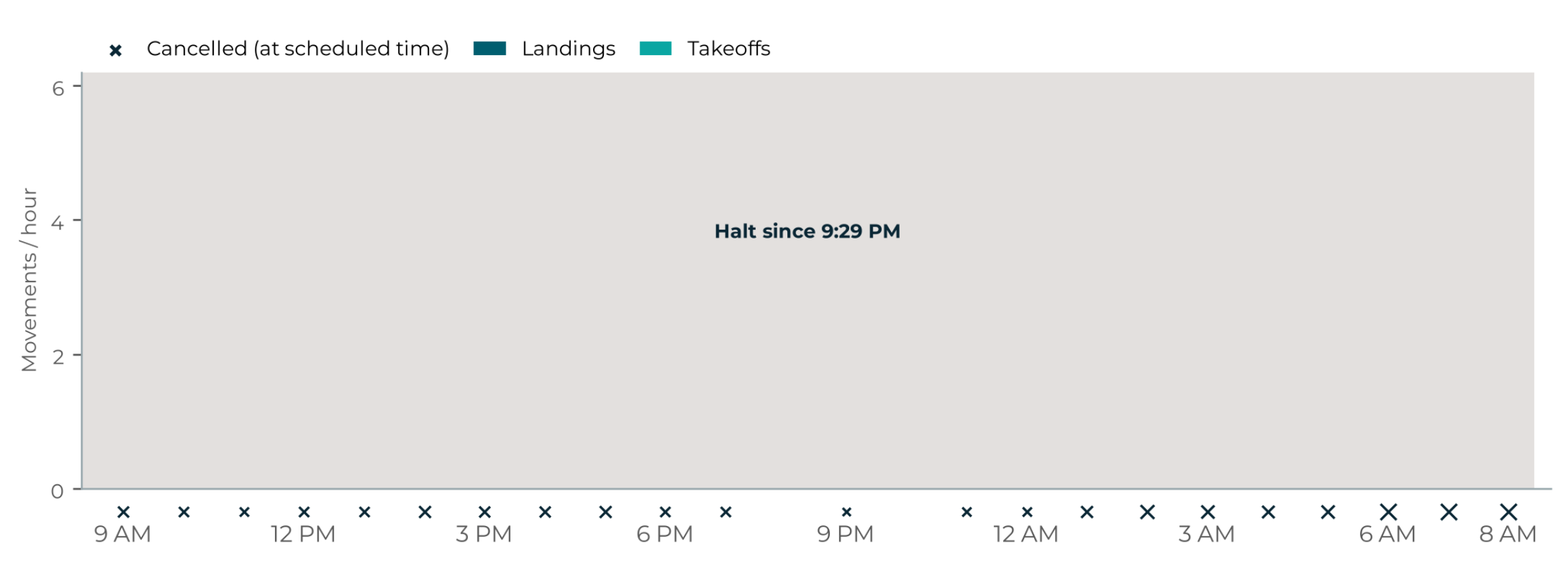
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	221
flynas	71
flyadeal	24
Qatar Airways	13
Riyadh Air	8

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	112
Madinah	31
Dubai	24
Dammam	22
Doha	15

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



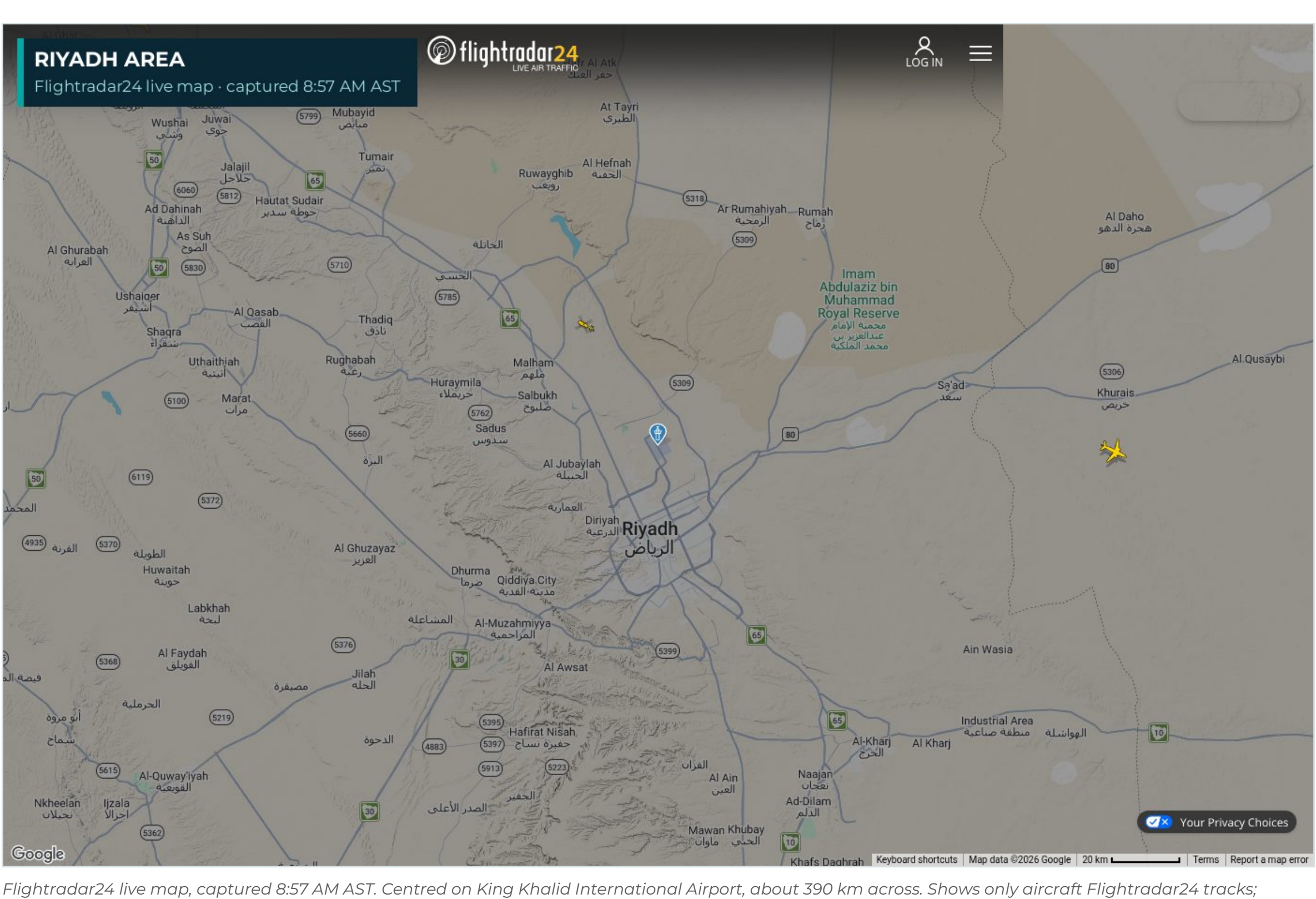
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 9:00 AM Saturday to 8:55 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam was halted from 2:49 to 4:29 AM; landings resumed at 4:29 AM and takeoffs at 4:54 AM. Earlier Dammam halts in the window ran 5:09–6:01 PM, 9:42–11:11 PM, 12:17–1:05 AM and 1:15–2:04 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	9326 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:57 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5

Dammam airport: disrupted. 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

42	8:17 AM	8:10 AM	1	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
22 departures + 20 arrivals, 19% of 217 scheduled.	F3461 to Madinah, 38 min before 8:55 AM.	XY402 from Jeddah, 46 min before 8:55 AM.	1 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:55 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 42 at 8:56 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**22**	**20**	**42**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**22 (20%)**	**20 (18%)**	**42**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**10 (9%)**	**8 (7%)**	**18**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**7 (41%)**	**9 (53%)**	**16**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**4 min**	**0 min**	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**14 of 30**	**14 of 30**	**28 of 60**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**1**	**4**	**5**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**15**	**14**	**29**	FR24 stats panel

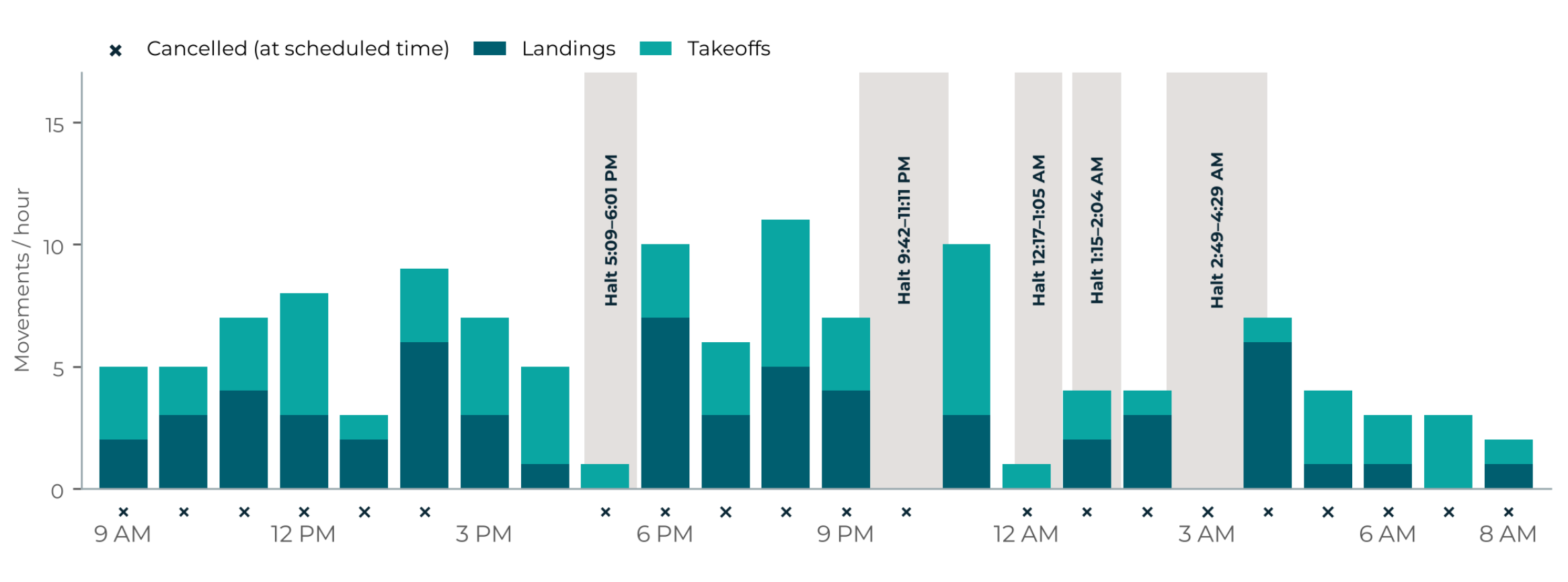
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	22
Egyptair	6
Qatar Airways	6
Turkish Airlines	2
flyadeal	2

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Riyadh	22
Cairo	6
Doha	6
Istanbul	2
Amman	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (62) and landings (60) at DMM per hour from 9:00 AM Saturday to 8:55 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

No halt since 2:49 to 4:29 AM (100 min). 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

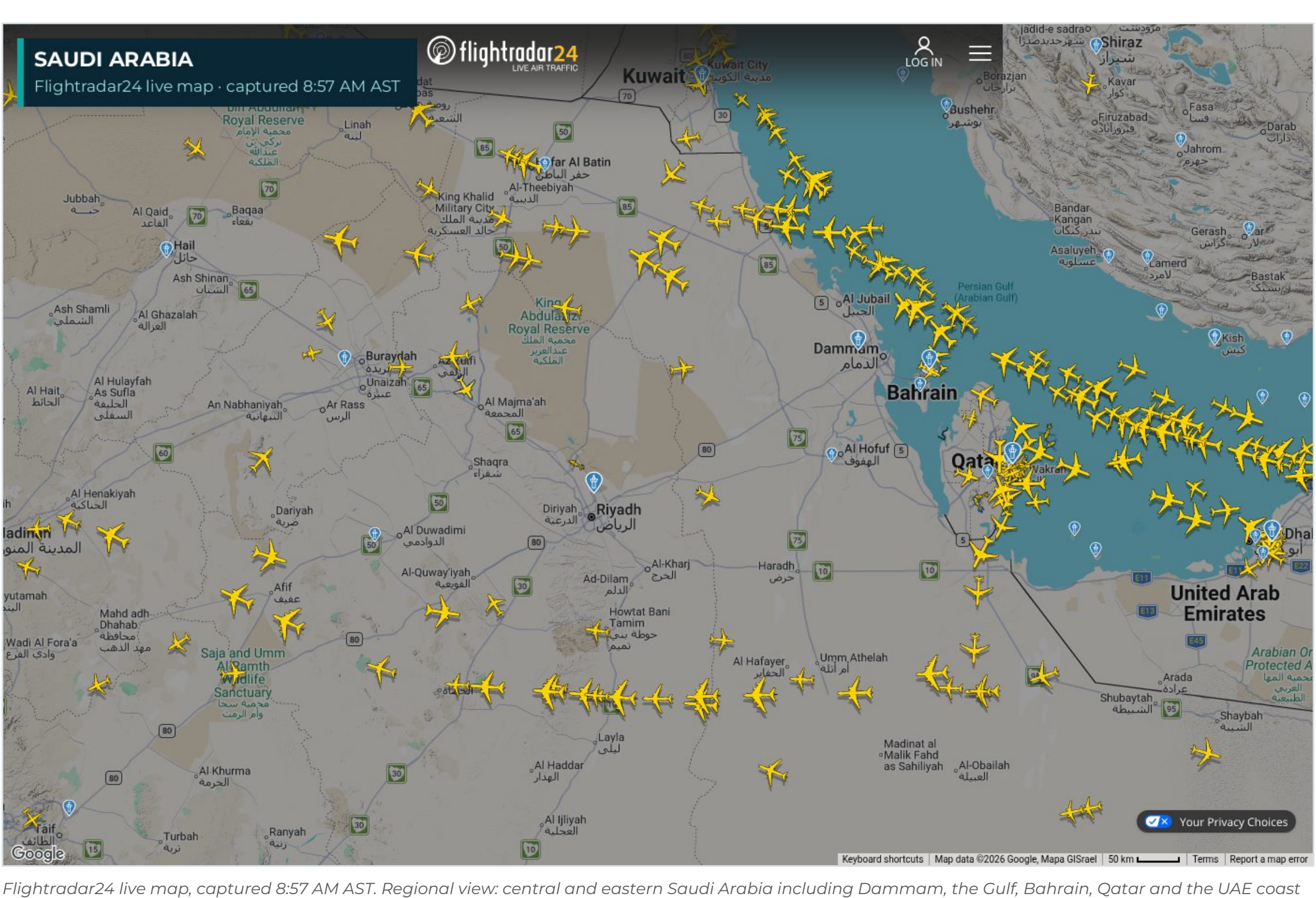
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 2:49–4:29 AM	100 min
Halt 1:15–2:04 AM	49 min
Halt 12:17–1:05 AM	48 min
Halt 9:42–11:11 PM	89 min
Halt 5:09–6:01 PM	53 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts claim air traffic halted at Dubai International, with inbound jets holding** (Social accounts on X (@CocoPostel, @abw__zayd) · 4:51 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:57 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

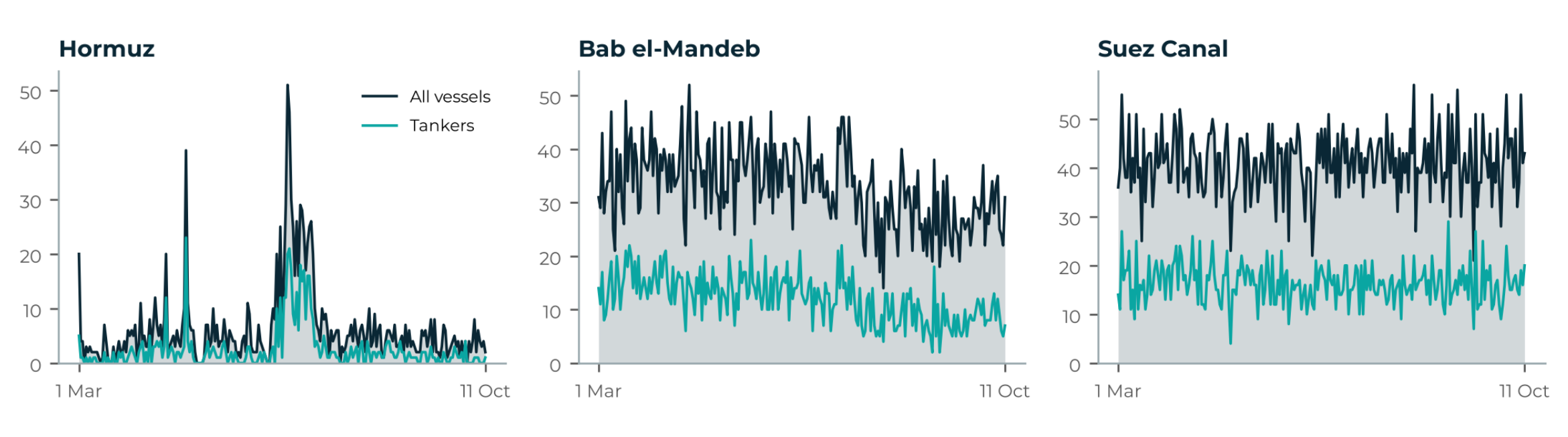
ECONOMY

6

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

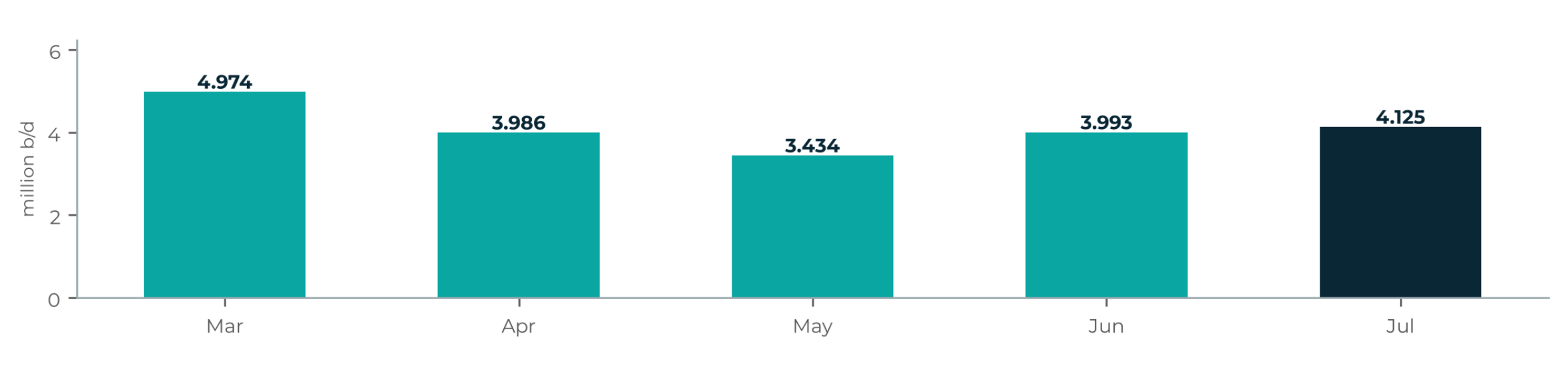
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 8:57 AM, Sun 18 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

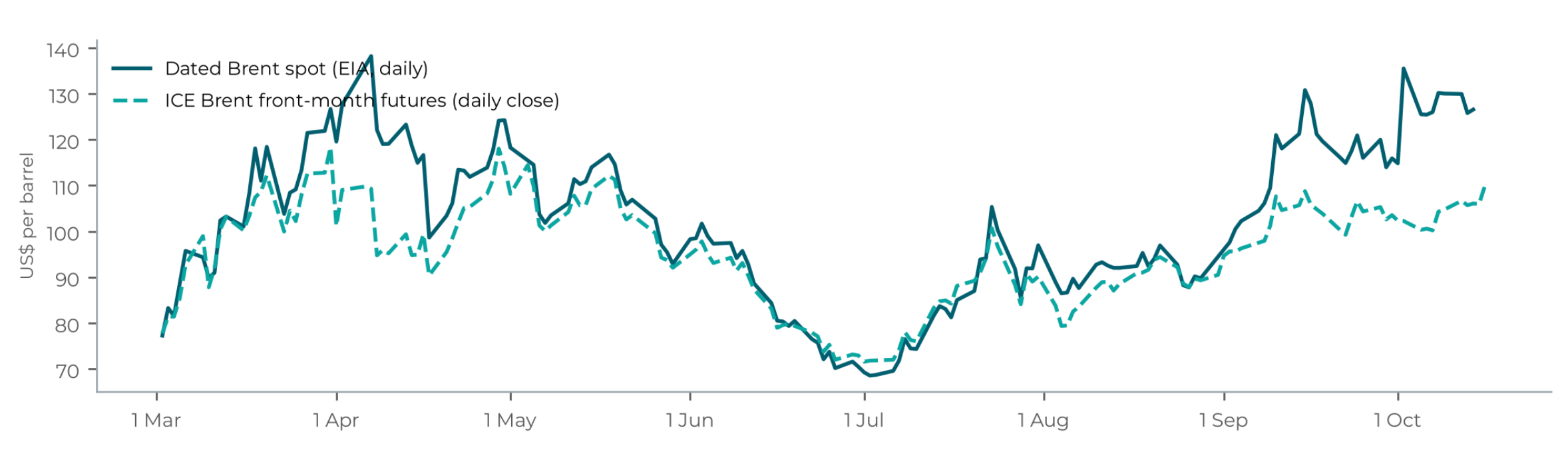


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

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What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 8:55 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
8:55 AM, Sun 18 Oct	8:55 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	10:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 10:00 AM